

US Weekly Prospects

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Economic and Policy Research

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North America Economic Research
US Weekly Prospects
14 August 2026

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United States

- **The July core CPI increased a moderate 0.2%, while the year-ago measure moved down to 2.5%**
- **However, we think the July core PCE inflation measure may be firm again**
- **Retail sales fell in July, in what we believe is a temporary setback**
- **Next week's FOMC minutes could shed light on the Committee's inflation tolerance**

This week brought the highly-anticipated July set of inflation reports. The outcome was generally seen as benign, though with a complicating twist. [The CPI increased only 0.1%](#) last month, and the ex-food and energy core rose 0.2%, in line with expectations. [The PPI was even tamer](#), with a flat headline reading and the core measure also up 0.2%. The complication comes when we map the components of the CPI and PPI used to estimate the core PCE inflation measure—the Fed's preferred inflation gauge: this exercise points to a firmer 0.3% gain last month. If realized, the year-ago print would rise to 3.4% in July from 3.3% in June.

Such a strong core PCE reading might embolden the hawks on the FOMC. The markets shrugged off this concern, however, with rates lower after the inflation reports were released. We broadly agree with this assessment. The estimated strength in last month's core PCE came in a category that is subject to doubts about its measurement (more on this below), which may lead Committee members to be cautious about hiking into a phantom inflation menace.

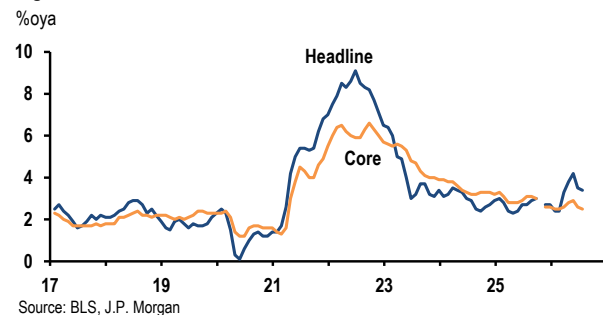
The notable data point on growth this week was the July retail sales report, which came in quite soft, as accurately signaled by our Chase card data. Total retail sales fell 0.6%, in part due to lower nominal spending at gasoline stations. Some of the weakness may also have been payback for the June promotion-day sales of a large online retailer, which pulled those sales forward out of July. We are inclined to view the July outcome as a minor soft patch, and continue to look for real consumer spending in 3Q to expand at a trend-like 1.75% annual pace.

It don't come easy

Markets were on edge ahead of Wednesday's CPI. In the event, the report came in quite close to expectations: the headline measure increased 0.1% (0.07%) and the core was up 0.2% (0.22%). The year-on-year figures both moved down a tenth, headline to 2.5% and core to 3.4% (Figure 1). Energy prices were down 1.5% on lower gas prices. Food prices rose a mercifully low 0.1%. Within the core basket, core goods, core services, and supercore (core services ex-housing) all

increased 0.2%. There wasn't much wild movement lurking below the surface of these calmly-behaved aggregates. One notable detail was the 3.5% increase in prices for personal computers and peripheral equipment, the most in over five years. This likely adds to the angst that the AI buildout isn't all positive for the economy.

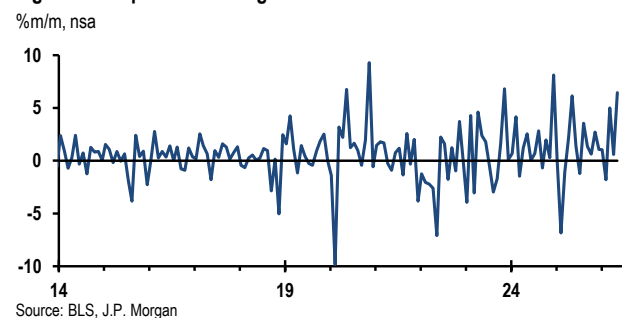
Figure 1: Headline and core CPI



The July PPI report also appeared uneventful, as final demand and producer prices were unchanged, with declining food and energy prices offsetting an as-expected 0.2% rise in the core final demand PPI. The deceleration in headline price pressures is encouraging, though price measures in the business surveys such as the ISM suggest it's too soon to sound the all-clear on pass-through from the war-related disruptions to supply chains—or possibly lingering tariff pressures.

Where things got weird was in the PPI measure of portfolio management services. That jumped 6.5% last month, contributing 13bp to our estimate of the July increase in core PCE prices (Figure 2). The PPI for portfolio management treats changes in fees collected due purely to asset revaluation as inflation. For example, if an asset manager charges a management fee that is a fixed percentage of AUM, and AUM rises 10% purely on account of higher market prices, then the PPI will register this gain as 10% inflation.

Figure 2: PPI portfolio management services



The BEA, which produces the PCE measure, has preferred this approach in the past because, under NIPA accounting, asset valuation changes should not mechanically affect real

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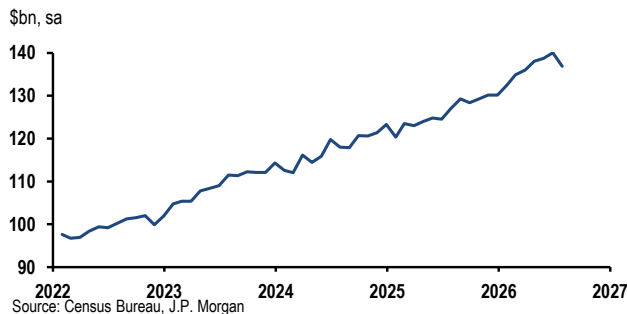
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output. Even so, the BEA has announced that it is changing the methodology for measuring portfolio management fees (and two other PCE categories) with a release date of September 30. We don't have enough detail on the new methodology to know exactly what the post-revision contours of this category will look like, but directionally it should lower measured inflation for portfolio management fees. This uncertainty may lead to some caution on the part of the FOMC at its September meeting, as they wouldn't want to hike because of inflation that is revised away two weeks after that meeting.

Consumers take a breather

[Our Chase card data](#)¹ had been flagging a pullback in retail spending last month, and the [Census Bureau's retail sales report](#) confirmed that stepdown. Total sales slid 0.6% last month, partly on a 0.9% decline in nominal spending at gas stations. However, even the core retail "control" category—which strips out food services, gasoline, building materials, and vehicles—declined 0.4% in July. The decline in this latter category was more than entirely due to a 2.2% decline in the large non-store category, which is primarily online fulfillment centers (Figure 3). One large online retailer usually has a sales promotion in July, but this year ran it in June, possibly changing behavior and distorting seasonal adjustment, both in a manner to lower seasonally-adjusted sales last month.

Figure 3: Retail sales at nonstore retailers



Given last month's retail sales and CPI reports, we estimate real consumer spending was unchanged in July. We continue to look for real consumer spending to expand at a 1.75% pace this quarter, a moderation from last quarter's 3.2% outcome but still close to trend. There are several reasons we're not panicking about the July soft patch for retail sales. Some of the weakness may reflect the one-time distortion from the promotion day mentioned above. Moreover, the July slip came after a very strong run for retail spending, and the three-month average annualized gain in "control" sales through

1. (Index File 2.0: Source: JPMorgan Chase Bank, NA, JPMC Index File 2.0, select Chase credit and debit card transaction data. See [here](#) for disclaimers and methodology.)

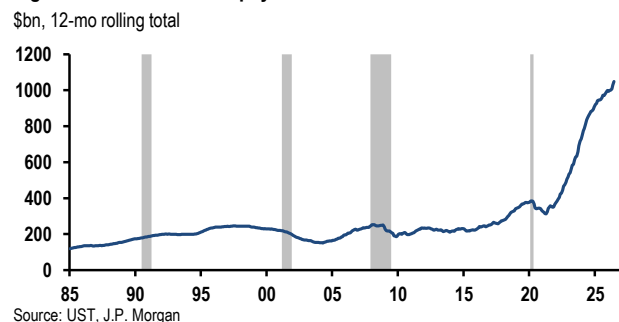
July is still a quite strong 5.6%. Finally, while we only have just over a week of data, the Chase card data—which has the hot hand—is pointing to a rebound in spending in August.

Nor do we see significant signs of stress in consumer credit quality. This week the NY Fed released its quarterly survey of household debt and credit. Total household debt decreased slightly last quarter, and transitions into early delinquencies were largely steady. The stock of credit over 90 days past due remains quite elevated by historical standards, but in a helpful [blog post](#) NY Fed economists discuss how this is largely an artifact of changes in credit bureau reporting practices.

Deficit barn door wide open

The July federal deficit was reported this week at \$432 billion. This took the 12-month rolling total to \$1.95 trillion. Some of last month's outcome was a timing issue related to Medicare payments. There was also the drag of ongoing tariff refund payments, which may have contributed around \$33 billion to last month's deficit. The Middle East conflict didn't help, as defense outlays were up. Perhaps most concerning were federal payments for interest on the debt, which exceeded \$100 billion for the third straight month, and now total \$1.05 trillion over the past 12 months (Figure 4). No amount of cost-cutting will stanch this ongoing drain on the fisc.

Figure 4: Federal interest payments



Say anything

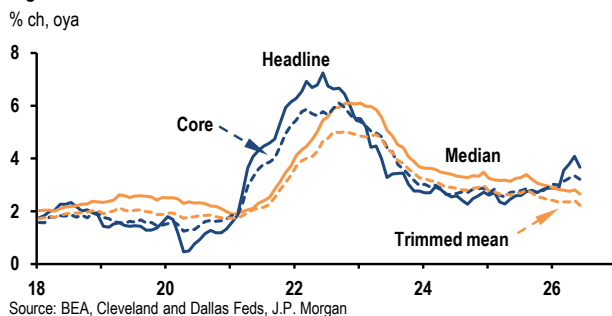
The data calendar lightens up next week. Scheduled releases include July's industrial production and early August's manufacturing surveys, as well as several housing indicators. The minutes to the late July FOMC meeting will be released mid-week. At that meeting, three members dissented in favor of higher rates. The minutes may give a sense of how much tolerance the rest of the Committee has for above-target inflation. While not officially on the schedule, Fed chair Warsh is likely to speak at the Jackson Hole conference, two days after the release of the above-mentioned July PCE inflation report. While this would be an opportune moment to discuss the nuances of the inflation data, we don't have high expectations for a thoroughgoing discussion of recent developments.

US Focus: Lags in robust PCE cores challenge policy

Chair Warsh's remarks on inflation measurement have renewed interest in alternatives such as the median and trimmed mean PCE. These "robust" or "limited-influenced" measures exclude big individual price swings. But their performance during the post-COVID inflation surge left much to be desired. The [Cleveland](#) and [Dallas](#) Feds found that they have been biased lower as the distribution of monthly price changes took on a positive skew instead of its usual negative one. Here we document another challenge: the signal from these robust measures notably lagged the surge in headline and core PCE during 2021-22, calling into question their usefulness for guiding monetary policy.

Specifically, headline inflation rose above 3% on a year-ago basis by April 2021 and above 4% by May, while core also crossed 3% in April and breached 4% in September. Meanwhile, median PCE didn't cross 3% until six months later and the trimmed mean until seven months later. These measures didn't reach 4% until January and March 2022, respectively—nearly a full year after the surge began (Figure 1).

Figure 1: PCE inflation measures

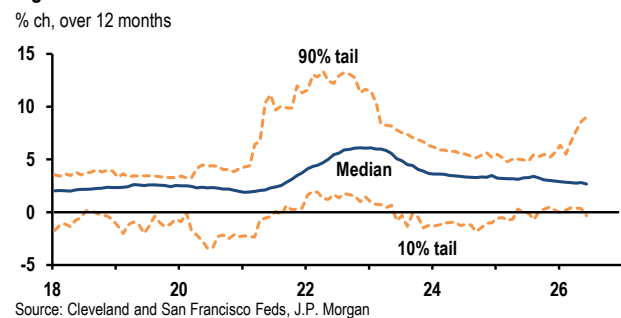


If some firms adjust prices sluggishly to shocks, the initial impact may show up only in a subset of prices—that is, in the tails of the distribution. By construction, robust cores exclude price changes in the tails as temporary or idiosyncratic: noise rather than signal. The mean or trimmed mean moves only after enough of the distribution of prices shifts. That eventually happened during the post-COVID inflation surge. But the lack of a sizable response in 2021 and into 2022 likely reinforced the Fed's belief that the inflation surge was transitory.

Figure 2 plots the 10% and 90% tails of the distribution of annual PCE price changes (from the San Francisco Fed) against the median measure (from the Cleveland Fed). The initial 2020 skew toward lower inflation as the pandemic shut down activity briefly helped nudge down median inflation early into 2021. But by then a sustained upward surge had

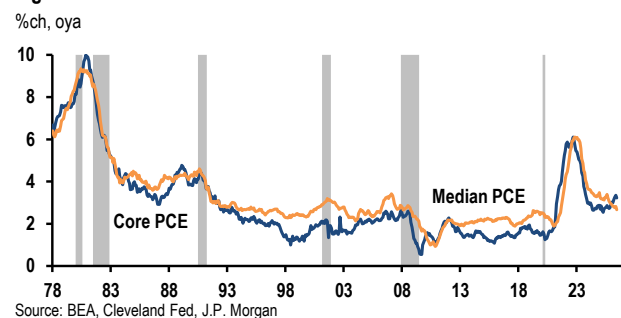
taken over the distribution. Even as headline and core moved higher contemporaneously (Figure 1), the median lagged until enough of the distribution had moved higher to pull it up. The same logic holds for the trimmed mean.

Figure 2: Distribution of PCE inflation



While 2021-22 is the most prominent (and recent) example of this lagged dynamic, similar instances arguably can be found in 1997-2000, 2009-10, and 2018-19. (Figure 3 shows just core and median PCE for clarity, but similar results hold across the inflation measures shown in Figure 1.) There is also a puzzling period of 2013-17 where core PCE inflation slowed but the median PCE did not. However, earlier episodes do not show as clear a lead-lag relationship.

Figure 3: Core and median PCE inflation



This idea is formalized in Table 1, which summarizes the cross-correlations of headline and core with either of the robust measures. In every case for the first half of the sample (through 2001), the pairwise correlation is maximized contemporaneously; for the second half, the correlation is highest when headline or core PCE is lagged by at least six months.

Table 1: Cross-correlations among PCE inflation measures

	Number of lags that maximize pairwise correlation			
	Median PCE		Trimmed mean	
	Lagged headline	Lagged core	Lagged headline	Lagged core
Jan 1978 - Dec 2001	0	0	0	0
Jan 2002 - Jun 2026	8	6	7	6

Source: J.P. Morgan

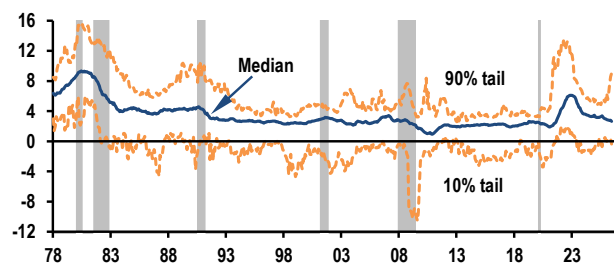
On the other hand, Granger causality tests do not provide consistent evidence of one set leading the other, although there is some tendency in the second half of the sample for headline or core to have incremental forecasting power for the robust measures, but not the converse. Thus the lead-lag relationship appears to vary over time and likely depends on the nature of the shock, which prices responded the most, and how Fed policy reacted.

The much longer sample in Figure 4 illustrates that spikes up (or down) often did not materially move the median. In other words, these were idiosyncratic or temporary price shocks that did not represent changes in underlying inflationary pressures—precisely what the median measure is designed to identify, and to ignore. Yet it also shows a larger set of examples for which the median has lagged shifts in the distribution: for example, higher in the late 1980s or lower in the late 2000s as a result of the Global Financial Crisis.

2.3%. Chair Warsh appears to be hoping that the latest moves up in the PCE inflation measures turn out to be transitory. He will likely have to wait longer for a verdict from the robust cores.

Figure 4: Distribution of PCE inflation

% ch, over 12 months



Source: Cleveland and San Francisco Feds, J.P. Morgan

So long as some prices adjust slowly, median and trimmed mean PCE measures will tend to lag in identifying persistent changes in inflation in real time—since, by construction, they treat movements in the tails as noise rather than signal. For any large and persistent shock to inflation, headline and core PCE—which do not filter out the tails of the distribution—both should rise or fall ahead of the trimmed mean or median measures, as the shock will show up first in the tails. While this dynamic was not as evident in the data several decades back, it can be seen in more recent periods, and most prominently in the latest surge in inflation during 2021-22.

Put another way, neither measure can be used to reliably identify persistent moves in inflation until well after the fact—and potentially only after policymakers end up behind the curve. This challenge remains today: each of the figures above again shows an increase in headline and core PCE inflation—and in the right tail of the distribution of price changes—that is not (yet) reflected in either of the robust measures. Indeed, after the July CPI and PPI reports, we are tracking core PCE inflation to inch up to 3.4%oya, whereas the median is tracking a more moderate 2.8% and the trimmed mean a much lower

Global Data Watch: Whooaa, we're half way there

- Consumer reliance has sustained the expansion, now jobs need to pick up
- Soft July data reduce odds of Fed Sep hike, still see hike by year-end
- Solid 2Q GDP in Western Europe with firming surveys for 3Q
- Next week: G4 Aug flash PMIs, China Jul activity, Riksbank hold

Incoming 2Q26 GDP reports highlight remarkable consumer strength through the energy shock (Figure 1). Over the prior year, Western European and US households have responded to little in real income gains by lowering personal savings rates. We estimate that G4 saving rates have fallen roughly 1.6%-pts since mid-2025, sustaining consumer spending growth of equal magnitude. Last quarter's 2%ar DM consumption gain was particularly impressive in the face of an energy price shock that compressed real incomes by 0.8%ar. This resilience has boosted DM nominal GDP by roughly 5% over the past four quarters, which in turn is generating a surge in corporate profits and reinforcing supportive financial conditions. The resulting impulse to business spending and sentiment at midyear bolsters confidence in our above-potential 2H26 global growth forecast. We look for this view to be supported by a consolidation in next week's August flash PMIs which would align with above-potential DM growth.

Although the latest disappointing data from the US are a reminder that expansions do not move in a straight line, we maintain our outlook for a cyclical lift to above-trend growth. Central to this call is a broadening in business spending to include a pickup in hiring. Consumers have spent on [wealth gains and hope](#) that the income slide will be reversed. Notwithstanding the disappointing US July employment and retail sales reports, a tentative pickup in DM job growth is underway (Figure 2). Our forecast looks for a rebound in business sentiment to lift job growth towards a 1%ar and stabilize wage inflation in 2H26.

Combined with the fading energy shock that lowers inflation, DM household purchasing power should accelerate from a 1%ar contraction last quarter to a 1.5%ar pace of growth in 2H26. The risk is that labor markets remain weak, wage disinflation continues, and consumer price inflation remains elevated. Absent the labor market recovery that households are hoping for to replace fading wealth effects, spending growth will deteriorate. This could short-circuit the lift in business optimism and further weigh on hiring. In turn, equity markets could start to falter, further depressing spending.

Figure 1: Real income and spending, G-4

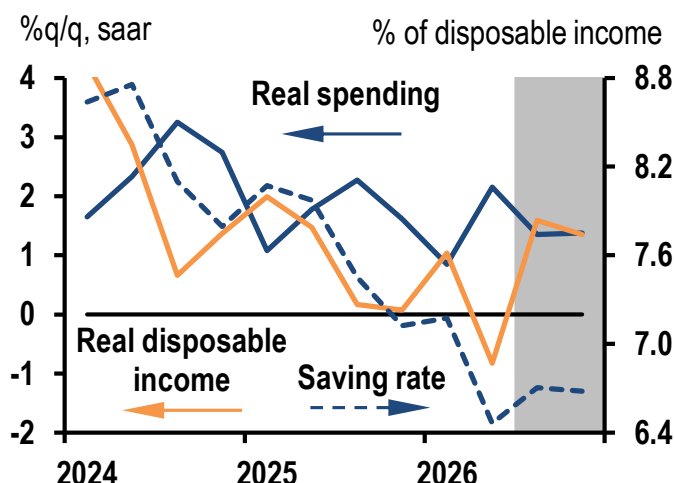
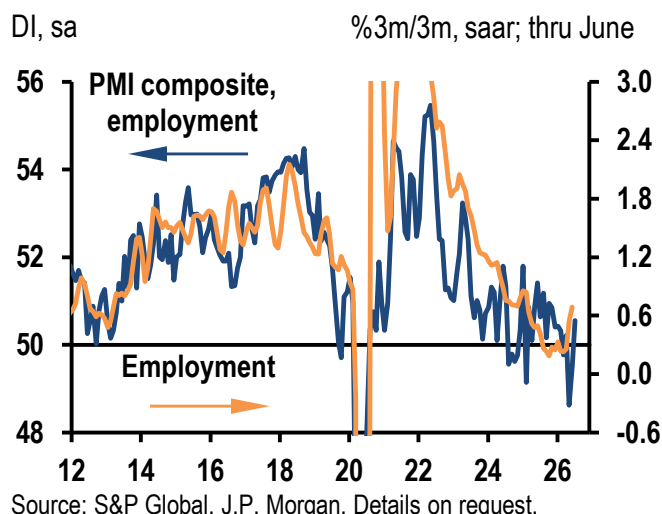


Figure 2: DM employment, PMI and actual



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Ready, set, hike

Next week's Riksbank meeting should complete a run of July-August meetings in which all nine DM central banks we track remained on hold. These holds are, however, a prelude to an expected round of hiking starting next month. We see three factors driving these actions. First, last quarter's resilient consumer removes lingering downside risks that justified patience in the face of the energy price shock. Indeed, incoming news is shifting central banks' growth forecasts higher, in line with our recent upgrades to materially above-potential 2H26 GDP growth. Second, growth resilience and supportive financial conditions raise new concerns that policy stances are less restrictive than are generally perceived. Finally, core inflation remains elevated broadly and the outlook ahead is murky at best. Combined, these factors make the case for central bankers to manage risk by taking action to assuage their most pressing concerns.

A September hike is most likely from the ECB, which has expressed a strong bias to lean against inflation pressures. This bias is reinforced by upbeat growth signals and continued headline inflation worries as the energy shock is lingering. Next week's August flash PMI should signal that the Euro area expansion is on track for modestly above-trend growth. A similar flash PMI message is expected for the UK, which posted a stronger-than-expected 1.7%q/q, saar gain last quarter. However, in contrast to the Euro area, next week's UK reports should show prices and wages on a better disinflationary track. Given also a greater willingness to look through the energy shock, we still see the BoE hiking in November, but this could be pushed back if inflation continues to surprise to the downside.

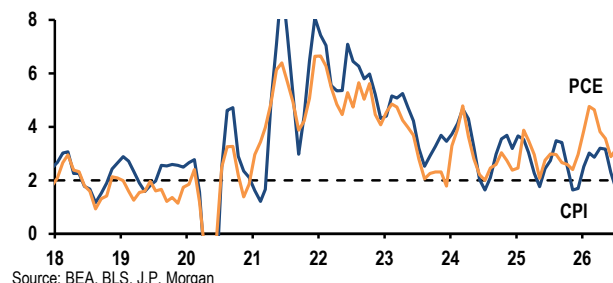
In Japan, concerns that normalization is moving too slowly are weighing on the BoJ. Currency pressures remain despite the Japan-US joint support. Combined with the government giving a green light for rate hikes, our call for a hike could get pulled from October to September. However, the BoJ has tended to proceed with gradual tightening while assessing the effects of previous hikes. A September move without a clear data catalyst would alter this pace and have the potentially unintended effect of fueling expectations for quarterly hikes. We maintain our October call but will be sensitive to yen depreciation as a catalyst for earlier action.

The decision from a divided FOMC will be data dependent. Last week's data flow left the committee grappling with an employment report in which job growth stalled while the unemployment rate fell. The inflation news is also sending mixed signals. While the trajectory of core CPI slowed to a 1.6%ar pace in the three months through July, core PCE inputs point to a more elevated 3.2%ar rise over this period (Figure 3). We believe that the incoming news is not suffi-

cient to push the committee's patient majority to hike in September. But our projection of better job growth and tighter labor markets ahead is expected to turn this tide before year-end.

Figure 3: US core inflation

%3m, saar; PCE incl. July forecast



Canada and Australia are the only two DM economies in which we do not envision rate hikes for the remainder of year. While Canada is rebounding from a contraction in GDP around the turn of the year, its jobless rate remains materially above estimates of full employment, and the BoC judges that the economy still exhibits excess supply. Meanwhile, the BoC has been one of the few central banks to have successfully returned inflation back to target. In Australia, the RBA kept rates on hold this week, while retaining a hawkish bias given still elevated inflation. However, Australia is expected to buck the tide of rising growth and rates as its domestic demand is softening, and the unemployment rate has increased.

Europe under the sun

Europe is facing an extended period of extreme heat, drought, and unusually low river levels. Parts of the continent are experiencing some of the driest conditions in decades. The combination of high temperatures and limited rainfall has pushed major waterways to exceptionally low levels, disrupting activity in agriculture, energy, and transportation. In the Euro area, low water levels on the Rhine have disrupted river transport and could weigh on parts of German industry, particularly chemicals, creating temporary downside risks to activity. Critically low river conditions weighed on German industry in 2018 and 2022. [Past research](#) suggests that whenever the Rhine remains critically low (below 78cm at the Kaub bottleneck) for 30 days, German IP drops by 1% and GDP is damped by 0.4%.

The hot, dry weather also has implications for energy production, reducing nuclear generation and increasing reliance on gas-fired power generation at a time when gas imports are constrained and inventories are low. In CEE, record-low Danube water levels have curtailed cooling-water availability at

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nuclear plants in Hungary and Romania. So far, higher imports and fuel switching have prevented major disruptions, but the episode has temporarily worsened external balances and raised power costs. The largest economic damage is likely to occur in agriculture, where drought conditions are weighing on crop yields.

Japan: The bonds that tie

Despite the joint Japan-US intervention to support the weakening yen, there has been no material change in Japan's fiscal policy stance and the growing concerns over debt sustainability. This week, Minister of State for Economic and Fiscal Policy Kiuchi—one of the key cabinet members promoting the government's initiatives—reiterated the administration's longstanding view that the “responsible proactive fiscal policy” would ultimately put upward pressure on the yen. This optimism rests on the belief that the current yen weakness is only transitory, reflecting near-term market perceptions that will fade with stronger growth. Economic indicators released this week point to broad-based improvement in business sentiment, and 2Q GDP, due next week, is expected to post well above potential of nearly 2%q/q saar. However, with growth running above potential, government stimulus will lead to inflation pressures—and thus the need for BoJ hikes—further amplifying concerns over debt issuance.

Slowing credit impulse tests China

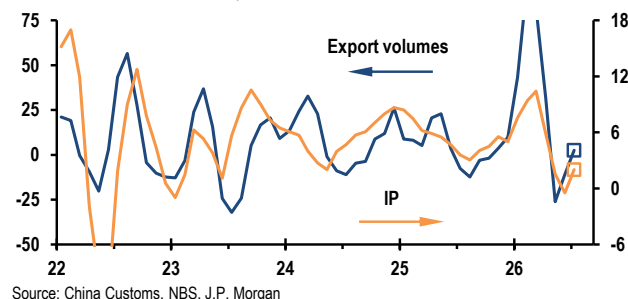
The incoming data over the past week point to continued domestic demand weakness and only a limited pickup in fiscal support. Both CPI and PPI softened more than expected, reflecting weak consumer demand, renewed disinflationary pressures, and subdued construction activity. While adverse weather likely contributed to the softness, the broader message is that demand momentum remains lackluster. The momentum loss is reinforced by slowing new bank loan creation. Combined with only modest acceleration in government bond issuance, the risk is that government efforts to boost demand this quarter are still lacking.

The external sector remains China's main growth engine, even as weakness in the domestic economy weighs on production. We expect July IP (out next week) to rise a modest 0.1%*m/m* but this comes on the back of June's 1% jump, returning the underlying trend to positive territory (Figure 4). Meanwhile, retail sales likely remained mild (+0.2%*m/m*) despite summer tourism seasonality, and fixed asset investment (-9%*o/y*) remains constrained by lagging fiscal deployment and weather-related disruptions to construction activity. Taken together, the July data will provide the first test of our constructive 2H growth outlook. While the recovery narrative remains intact, it is becoming increasingly reliant on fiscal policy delivery. Without a more visible fiscal catch-up, export

resilience alone may not be sufficient to offset persistent weakness in domestic demand.

Figure 4: China real exports and IP

%3m/3m, saar; both scales, July fcst boxed



Romania: Cutting through the storm

Absent a working government for the past 100 days, the task of reducing Romania's 9% 2024 fiscal deficit down to 3% is daunting. Along with the help of significant incoming EU grants (EUR4.5bn under EU's RRF) and the authorities delivering a better-than-expected fiscal tightening to below 6% this year, sovereign debt narrowly escaped a downgrade. Improving fiscal discipline and a large negative output gap in the face of fiscal tightening is prompting a dovish turn from the NBR. We expect 50bp of cuts next year, but this could start earlier than our forecast for 2Q27 and cumulate to more.

Latam: Policy and politics in the spotlight

Politics are in focus across Latin America. In a sharp shift from the prior leftist Petro administration, the conservative de la Espriella was sworn in on August 7 as Colombia's president. Despite lacking a legislative majority, his early governing style has emphasized speed, discipline, and a “security-first” posture. The administration's headline message is pro-investment and recognizing fiscal realism, resetting expectations on the size of the deficit, and promising austerity and a growth-oriented overhaul, while also positioning private sector investment as a key driver for growth recovery. The August 10 earthquake adds an immediate reconstruction imperative that is, understandably, reshaping near-term priorities. Elsewhere, Brazil formally enters the 2026 presidential campaign this weekend, with investors likely to focus increasingly on candidates' fiscal proposals amid persistent concerns over debt dynamics and the medium-term policy outlook.

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US Indicator forecasts

J.P. Morgan Research versus the consensus

Release date/ Indicator	J.P. Morgan forecast	Consensus median	Consensus range
Mon, Aug 17			
Empire State survey (Aug)	10.0	11.5	5.0 to 15.0
NAHB survey (Aug)	34	33	31 to 35
Tue, Aug 18			
Housing starts (Jul)	1310k	1350k	1300k to 1483k
Permits	1370k	1375k	1344k to 1400k
Import prices (Jul)	-0.5%	0.1%	-0.7% to 0.5%
Industrial production (Jul)	0.3%	0.3%	-0.1% to 0.6%
Capacity utilization	76.2%	76.3%	76.1% to 76.6%
Pending home sales (Jul)	0.6%	0.0%	-1.0% to 1.1%
Thu, Aug 20			
Initial claims (w/e Aug 15)	215k	211k	198k to 215k
Philly Fed survey (Aug)	25.0	24.8	12.0 to 33.1
Fri, Aug 21			
Manufacturing PMI (Aug flash)	53.5	53.9	53.0 to 54.5
Services PMI (Aug flash)	53.5	54.0	52.4 to 54.5

Source: J.P. Morgan, consensus forecasts reported by Bloomberg Finance L.P.

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North America Economic Research
US Weekly Prospects
14 August 2026

J.P.Morgan

Sources for all: ADP/Moody's Analytics, BEA, BLS, Census Bureau, Conference Board, Department of Labor, Federal Reserve Board, ISM, J.P. Morgan forecasts, NAHB, NAR, NFIB, NY Fed, Philadelphia Fed, S&P Global, Standard & Poor's, University of Michigan, US Treasury

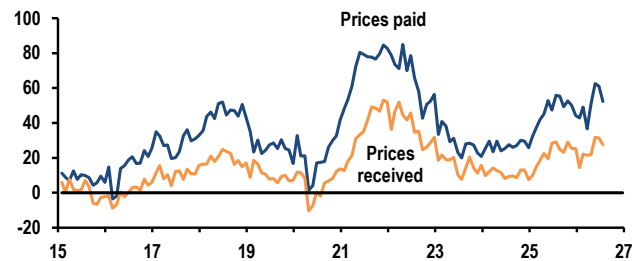
Empire State manufacturing					
Diffusion indices, sa					
Mon Aug 17 8:30am		May	Jun	Jul	Aug
General bus. conditions		19.6	5.7	15.6	10.0
New orders		22.7	3.5	22.2	
Shipments		18.9	8.6	24.4	
Employment		8.3	9.6	11.4	
Delivery times		20.4	11.9	13.0	
Inventories		9.7	0.0	4.0	
Prices paid		62.6	61.0	52.3	
Prices received		31.8	31.4	27.6	
Composite		58.0	53.4	57.5	

We expect the Empire State manufacturing survey to moderate to 10.0 in August, from 15.6 in July. The ISM-weighted index has been rising since the turn of the year, reaching a cycle high of 58.0 in May before falling briefly to 53.4 in June and recovering to 57.5 in July. Both new orders and shipments mirrored this trend, while unfilled orders reached a peak of 10.8 in March before falling to a still-elevated level of 5.0 in the last two reports. Some of this increase in the backlogs of work has been reflected in a steady improvement in the employment gauge, which has picked up to 11.4, the best level in close to three and a half years.

Inflationary pressures in the Empire survey have been moderating since the peak in May, partially reflecting a broad downturn in global energy prices. The prices paid metric fell to 52.3 in July from 61.0 in the prior month, while the prices received measure ticked down to 27.6 from 31.4. Future expectations of business conditions fell marginally in July, along with an uptick in capex plans, which remain at the upper end of their post-pandemic range.

Empire State survey prices paid and received

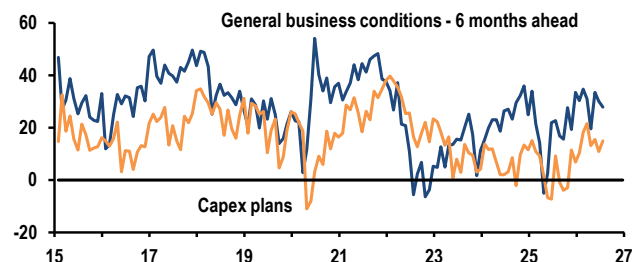
Index, sa



Source: FRBNY, J.P. Morgan

Empire State survey future business expectations and capex plans

Index, sa



Source: FRBNY, J.P. Morgan

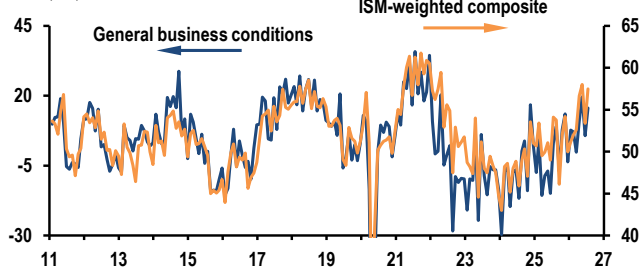
Homebuilders survey					
Sa					
Mon Aug 17 10:00am		May	Jun	Jul	Aug
Housing market		37	36	34	34
Present sales		40	38	37	
Sales: next 6 months		45	45	43	
Prospective buyer traffic		25	25	23	

We look for the NAHB Housing Market Index to remain at 34 in August, matching the lowest reading this year. In the July report, the present sales index edged down to 37 from 38, while the gauge of prospective buyers traffic cooled to 23 from 25. Muted demand is likely a symptom of the continued rise in borrowing costs, as mortgage rates have climbed to their highest levels in a year.

In the face of still-elevated inventories and continued dependence on price concessions and incentives to prop up sales, homebuilders are unlikely to increase the pace of new construction. The [press release for July](#) noted that any benefits on the supply side from the newly enacted 21st Century ROAD to Housing Act will take time to come to fruition.

Empire State survey and ISM-weighted composite

Index, sa, both scales



Source: FRBNY, J.P. Morgan

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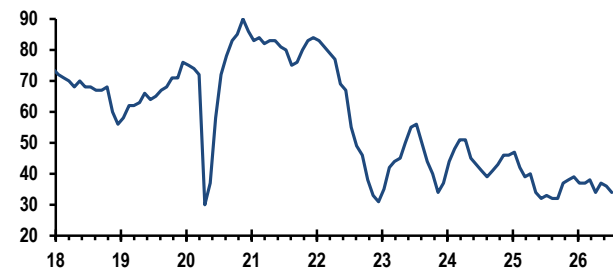
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NAHB homebuilder survey

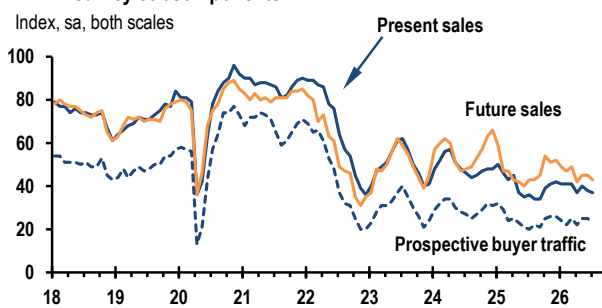
Index, sa



Source: NAHB, J.P. Morgan

NAHB survey subcomponents

Index, sa, both scales



Source: NAHB, J.P. Morgan

Tue Aug 18 8:30am						
Import prices						
%m/m, nsa, unless noted						
	Apr	May	Jun	Jul		
Import prices	2.1	1.7	0.3	<u>-0.5</u>		
%oya	4.3	6.6	7.1	<u>6.3</u>		
Ex-fuel import prices	0.6	0.7	0.4	<u>0.1</u>		
%oya	2.8	3.5	4.2	<u>4.2</u>		

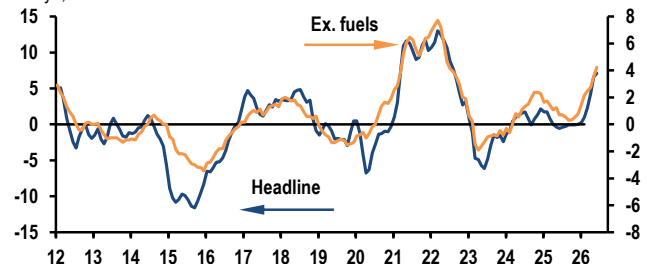
We expect total import prices fell by 0.5% m/m in July, as the earlier surge in energy prices continues to unwind. If realized, the over-year-ago pace would tick down to 6.3%, which would still mark the highest pace outside of the last two reports. Petroleum prices in June fell by only 0.7%, despite a larger drop in spot prices, likely reflecting the arrival of products that could have been contracted earlier at higher prices. As most of these contracts expire, we could see a material pullback in this segment in the July print, although elevated fuel oil prices could be a slight offset.

We project nonfuel import prices rose by 0.1% m/m, holding the over-year-ago pace at the cycle high of 4.2%. Inflationary pressures in the capital goods segment continue to be driven by computers, peripherals, and semiconductors, which rose 0.7% in June. However, the PPI index for computer storage devices remained flat in July, which could signal some moderation in the computers et al category. Outside of technology products, a slight appreciation of the US dollar in earlier months could help slow import price inflation in the coming reports. Non-fuel industrials have also been increasing in recent months, partially reflecting a uptick in metal prices, as import prices for unfinished metal jumped 31%oya in June.

While this number includes precious metals, other categories like steel and copper have also been rallying higher, despite the fact that these import price gains are reported before tariffs.

Import prices: headline and ex. fuels

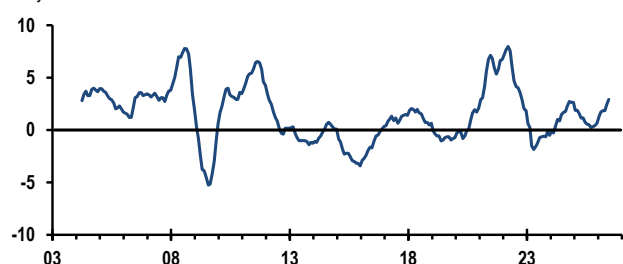
%oya, both scales



Source: BLS, J.P. Morgan

Import prices - ex fuels and computers

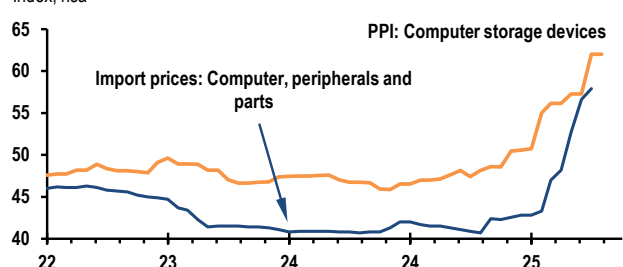
%oya



Source: BLS, J.P. Morgan

Comp, peripherals, and parts IPI and Comp storage devices PPI

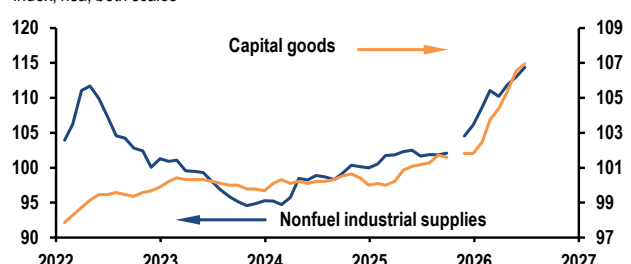
Index, nsa



Source: BLS, J.P. Morgan

Import prices for nonfuel industrial supplies, capital goods

Index, nsa, both scales



Source: BLS, J.P. Morgan

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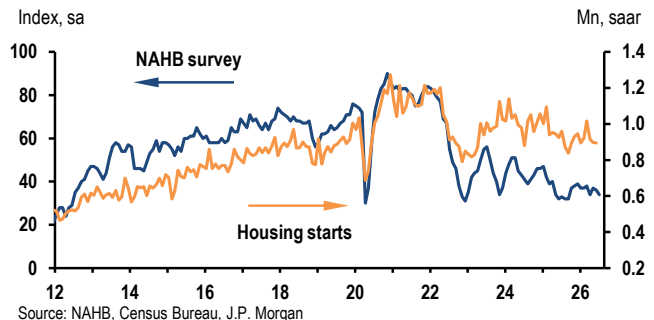
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Housing starts					
Million units, saar					
		Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Starts		1.41	1.20	1.43	1.31
Single-family starts		0.91	0.90	0.90	0.89
Multifamily starts		0.50	0.30	0.53	0.42
Permits		1.42	1.41	1.37	1.37
Single-family permits		0.88	0.89	0.87	0.86
Multifamily permits		0.54	0.52	0.50	0.51

We expect total housing starts to pull back 8.2%/m/m to 1.31mn in July, along with a smaller 0.3%/m/m decline in total permits. Total starts have been volatile in recent months, driven by swings in the multifamily segment, which spiked 76.2% in the last report. The single-family category continues to steadily decline, down 5.4% since the beginning of the year, and the 2.4% drop in permits for the category suggests continued softness in the coming months.

A combination of high inventory levels along with subdued demand due to affordability concerns among buyers continues to weigh on the prospects for new construction. The NAHB gauge of current home sales declined in both June and July to even further below historical norms as mortgage rates continued to move higher.

NAHB survey and single-family housing starts



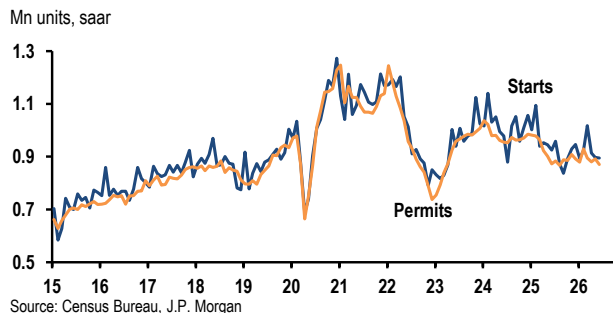
Industrial production					
%m/m,sa, unless noted					
		Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Industrial production		0.8	0.1	0.1	0.3
Manufacturing		0.7	0.1	0.0	0.0
Motor vehicles and parts		2.8	1.8	0.7	-1.9
High-tech		1.4	1.8	0.5	
Mfg ex motor vehicles		0.5	0.0	-0.1	0.1
Business equipment		1.7	0.9	-0.4	
Mining		1.3	1.1	0.4	1.0
Utilities		0.8	-0.7	0.4	1.2
Capacity utilization (%sa)		76.1	76.1	76.1	76.2
Manufacturing		75.7	75.8	75.7	75.6

We expect total IP for July to rise 0.3%/m/m, slightly faster than the tepid growth of the prior two months. Much of the recent strength in production came from durable goods manufacturing, which was up 3.4% cumulatively from the beginning of the year through May, before falling 0.1% in the last print. For July, we look for motor vehicles and parts to decline further by 1.6%, as informed by auto production schedule data. While the aircraft segment saw a 0.2% drop in June, strong readings of durable goods orders in the segment should support steady growth in manufacturing activity.

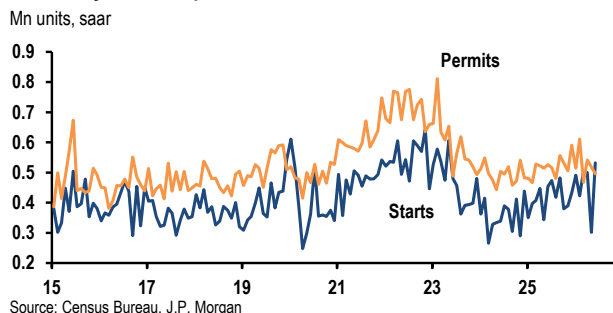
Outside of autos, we expect manufacturing output to rise 0.1%, similar to the 0.1% rise in average weekly hours for production and non-supervisory workers. While the manufacturing composites from the ISM and PMI surveys rose in June, the PMI index for output moderated to 53.9 from 56.2 in June. The ISM metric of production jumped to a cycle high of 58.5 in July from 52.2 in June.

Demand for AI-related equipment in select high-tech industries is also likely to support headline manufacturing growth. In June, computer and peripheral equipment fell by 0.5%, and electrical equipment, which had been boosted by electrification demand for data centers, dropped 0.6%. In July, we look for a 1.2% increase in utilities, likely reflecting increased cooling demand due to higher-than-usual temperatures, evident in an uptick in cooling degree day deviations.

Single-family starts vs. permits



Multifamily starts vs. permits



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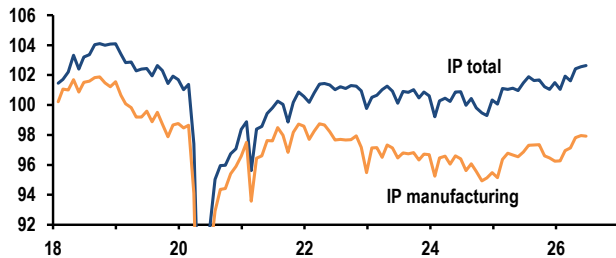
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Industrial production: overall and manufacturing only

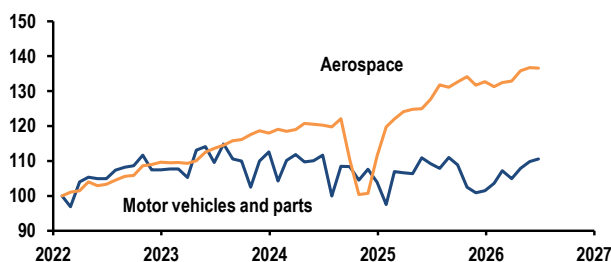
Index, sa



Source: Federal Reserve Board, J.P. Morgan

IP: motor vehicles and parts, aerospace

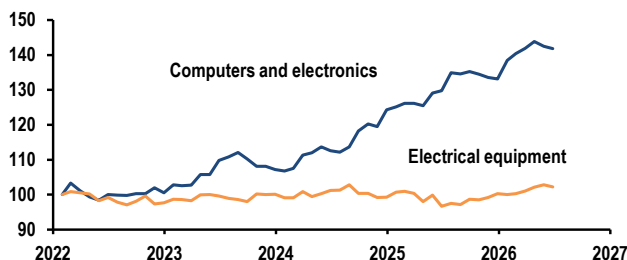
Index, Jan 2022 = 100



Source: Federal Reserve Board, J.P. Morgan

IP computers and electronics, electrical equipment

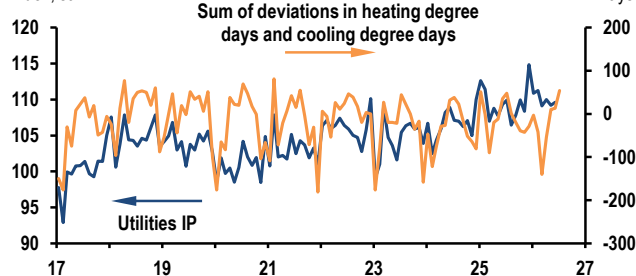
Index, Jan 2022 = 100



Source: Federal Reserve Board, J.P. Morgan

Utilities production and heating/cooling degree day deviations

Index, sa



Source: Federal Reserve Board, NOAA, J.P. Morgan

Pending home sales

Tue
Aug 18
10:00am

sa, unless noted

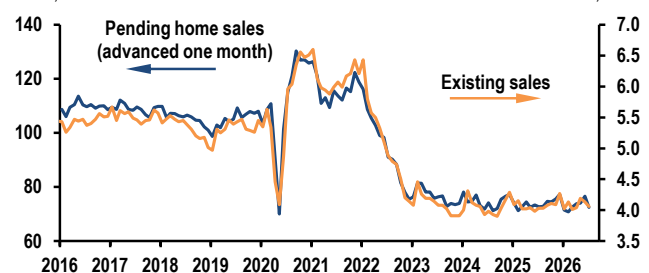
	Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Total (Index)	74.0	76.6	72.5	73.0
%ch m/m	0.3	3.8	-5.4	0.6
%oya (sa)	2.1	4.8	-0.3	0.2

We expect pending home sales to rise 0.6%/m to 73.0 in July. This modest increase reflects some normalization from a large 5.4% drop in June, as well as an improvement in the NAR Housing Affordability Index last month. That said, mortgage rates climbed a further 13bp between the last week of June and July, reaching their highest levels in a year, and will continue to keep many buyers and sellers on the sidelines. Mortgage purchase applications dropped 6.2% in July but have disconnected somewhat from the sales data in recent years.

The sharp fall in sales in the June report [was attributed to](#) high borrowing costs and a “record-high national median home price.” Higher mortgage rates have exacerbated the lock-in effect, where homeowners with low rates are reluctant to sell, constraining the supply of homes.

Pending home sales and existing home sales

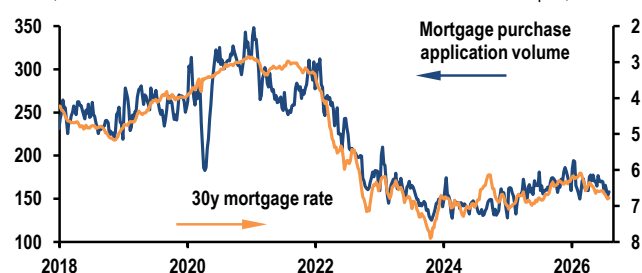
Index, sa



Source: NAR, J.P. Morgan

Mortgage activity and mortgage interest rates

Index, sa



Source: MBA, J.P. Morgan

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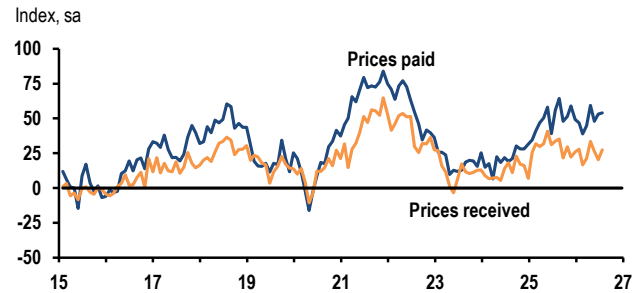
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Philadelphia Fed manufacturing					
Diffusion indices, sa					
	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	
General bus. conditions	-0.4	10.3	41.4	<u>25.0</u>	
New orders	-1.7	27.3	37.0		
Shipments	4.9	14.9	33.7		
Employment	-2.8	7.9	10.0		
Delivery times	-10.4	-2.6	9.6		
Inventories	6.6	-8.5	0.3		
Prices paid	47.9	53.2	53.9		
Prices received	26.3	20.3	27.4		
Composite	49.7	53.9	59.1		

We look for the August Philadelphia Fed manufacturing survey to decline to 25.0 from 41.4 in the prior month. General business conditions in the July report marked one of the best levels historically, jumping to 41.1 from 10.3 in June, along with the shipments metric rising to 33.7 from 14.9. This pushed the ISM-weighted measure from 53.1 to 58.1 in July, the highest in over one and a half years. The index for unfilled orders increased further in July to 18.1 from 10.5 in June and -2.5 in May, which could help sustain activity and employment at strong levels.

Against this backdrop, the price indexes in the Philadelphia Fed survey have diverged from the message of moderation conveyed by the Empire and national ISM and PMI manufacturing surveys. The index for prices paid inched higher to 53.9 from 53.2 in June, and prices received rose to 27.4 from 20.3, with both indexes slightly below their April peaks.

Philadelphia Fed mfg: prices paid and received



Source: Philadelphia Fed, J.P. Morgan

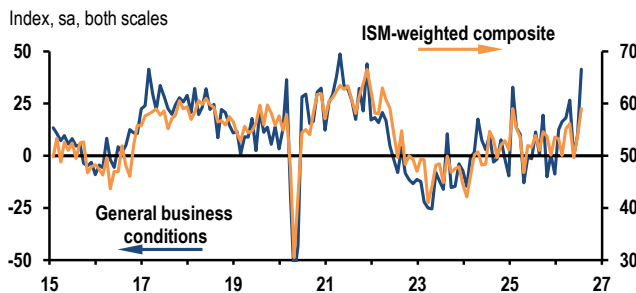
Jobless claims					
Thousands, sa					
	New claims (wr.)		Continuing claims		Insured Jobless, %
	Wkly	4-wk avg	Wkly	4-wk avg	
Jun 6	230	219	1800	1786	1.2
Jun 13 ¹	227	224	1812	1792	1.2
Jun 20	216	225	1806	1801	1.2
Jun 27	217	223	1821	1810	1.2
Jul 4	217	219	1798	1809	1.2
Jul 11	209	215	1789	1804	1.2
Jul 18 ¹	189	208	1777	1796	1.2
Jul 25	198	203	1799	1791	1.2
Aug 1	200	199	1777	1786	1.2
Aug 8	209	199			
Aug 15 ¹	<u>215</u>	<u>206</u>			

1. Payroll survey week

We expect initial jobless claims to inch up to 215k in the week ending August 15, from 209k in the prior week. The series has been running below prior years since falling to a historical low of 189k through mid-July. While some softness in early August readings was expected due to residual seasonality, the persistently negative gap to prior years could be a positive sign for the labor market, although the series has shown some signs of normalization in the last report.

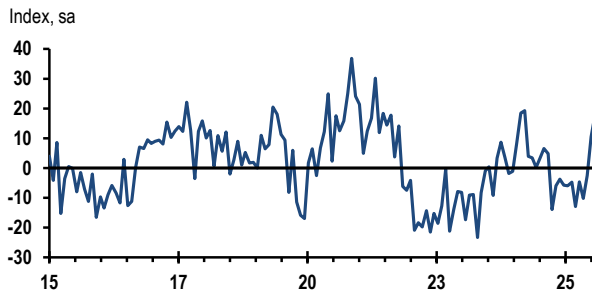
Continuing claims through the end of July fell 22k to 1.777mn, reversing all of the rise in the earlier week when the series similarly rose by 22k. The four-week average of continuing claims dropped to 1.786mn, further declining to -8.2% oya. This reading points to the unemployment rate remaining at current levels, absent further swings in the participation rate.

Philadelphia Fed mfg: general conditions, ISM-weighted composite



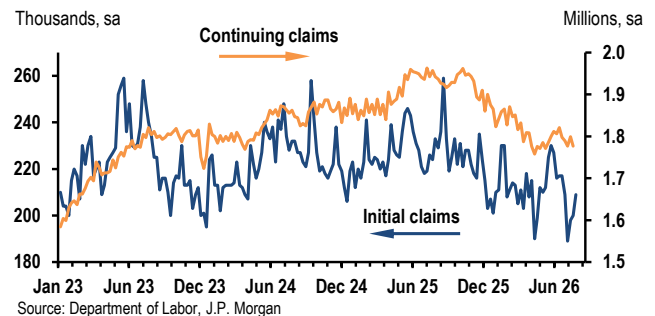
Source: Philadelphia Fed, J.P. Morgan

Philadelphia Fed mfg: unfilled orders



Source: Philadelphia Fed, J.P. Morgan

Jobless claims



Source: Department of Labor, J.P. Morgan

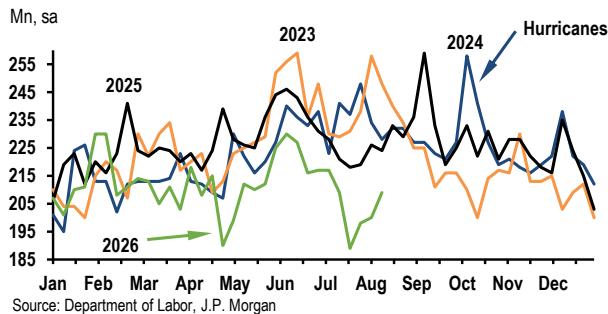
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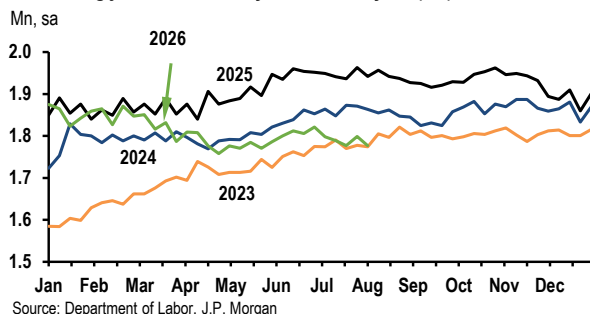
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Initial jobless claims, comparison by week to prior years (SA)



Continuing jobless claims, by week of the year (SA)

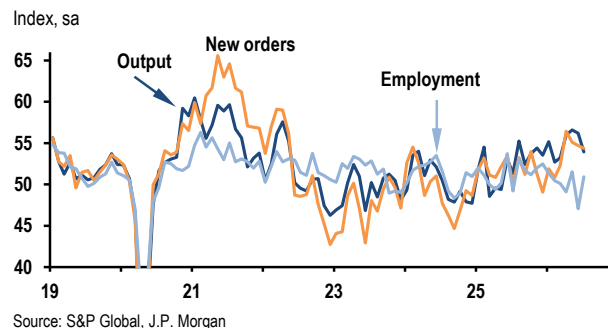


S&P Global manufacturing PMI (US flash)				
Fri	Index, sa			
Aug 21				
9:45am		Jul 25	Jul 26	Aug 26
	Composite	49.8	53.9	<u>53.5</u>
	Output	51.3	53.9	
	ISM-weighted composite	49.4	53.9	

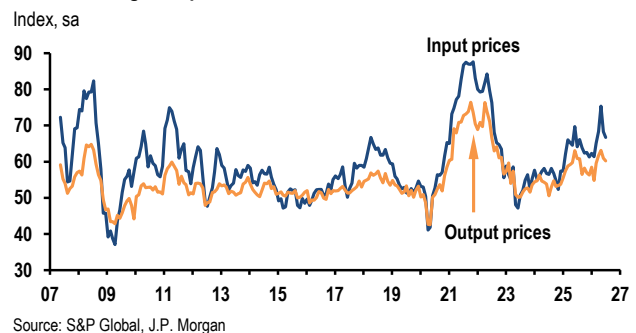
We look for the August flash manufacturing PMI to inch down to 53.5 from 53.9 in the prior month. After reaching a peak of 55.1 in May, the series ticked down slightly to 53.9 in the following month, with the [press release](#) attributing this to an unwind in precautionary demand as firms had previously front-loaded to get ahead of high prices and supply chain issues. The output index fell from 56.2 in June to 53.9 in July, slightly above the pre-conflict reading of 53.2 in March, while new orders moved from 54.7 to 54.4 in July, remaining elevated from 52.2 in March.

The impact of the Middle East conflict remained evident in the June report, which signaled a fall in inventories and lengthening supplier delivery times, coupled with declining expectations for future output. However, inflationary pressures eased, as input prices fell to 66.7 in July from 68.3 and output prices dropped to 60.2 from 61.0, although both indexes remain at elevated levels.

Manufacturing PMI: output, new orders, and employment



Manufacturing PMI: prices



S&P Global services PMI (US flash)				
Fri	Index, sa			
Aug 21				
9:45am		Jul 25	Jul 26	Aug 26
	Business activity	55.7	54.6	<u>53.5</u>
	New business	54.1	54.2	

We expect the August flash services PMI to moderate to 53.5 from 54.6 in the final July print. The July survey [noted](#) a boost in activity from the World Cup and US Independence Day events, the impact of which could begin to unwind in August. Business activity had been on a steady decline since the middle of last year before rising 3.9 points between May and July. The new business metric grew 3.5 points to 54.2 over this period.

Unlike its manufacturing counterpart, inflationary pressures in the PMI services readings remain firm. Both input and output prices had been broadly moving sideways since the beginning of the Middle East conflict before rising markedly in July. Input prices jumped to 63.0 in July from 59.9 in June, and output prices firmed to 58.5 from 57.8. Firms remain optimistic about the outlook, with expectations of future activity continuing to recover from a trough of 58.9 in May to 64.2 in July.

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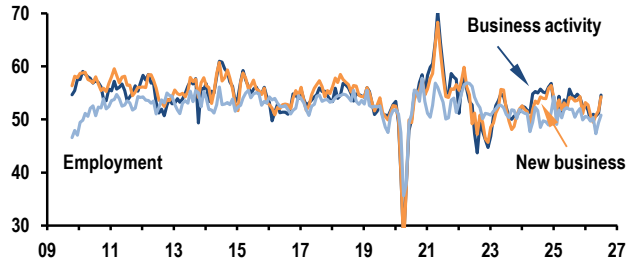
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Services PMI: business activity and components

Index, sa



Services PMI: prices

Index, sa



Services PMI: future business activity

Index, nsa



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J.P. Morgan US forecast

	%q/q, saar								%q4/q4			%y/y		
	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	2025	2026	2027	2025	2026	2027
Gross domestic product														
Real GDP	0.5	2.1	1.5	2.5	1.8	2.3	2.3	1.8	2.0	2.0	2.0	2.1	2.1	2.0
Final sales	0.3	1.9	2.2	1.2	1.2	2.2	2.2	1.8	2.2	1.6	2.0	2.2	2.2	1.8
Domestic	0.6	2.2	3.1	2.4	2.2	2.4	2.4	1.9	1.8	2.5	2.2	2.4	2.2	2.3
Consumer spending	1.9	0.5	3.2	1.8	1.5	2.0	2.0	1.5	2.1	1.7	1.7	2.6	2.0	1.9
Business investment	2.4	10.6	8.4	6.4	6.4	4.6	4.6	3.7	5.6	8.0	4.1	4.1	6.7	5.2
Equipment	4.3	15.8	15.2	10.0	10.0	5.0	5.0	4.0	9.6	12.7	4.5	8.3	10.6	6.9
Structures	-6.5	-4.7	-5.0	-4.0	-4.0	2.0	2.0	2.0	-5.5	-4.4	2.0	-5.3	-5.2	-0.4
Intellectual property products	5.4	13.8	8.8	7.0	7.0	5.0	5.0	4.0	8.0	9.1	4.5	5.6	9.0	5.6
Residential investment	-1.7	-7.8	1.5	0.0	0.0	4.0	6.0	3.0	-3.8	-1.6	4.0	-2.2	-3.3	2.8
Government	-5.6	4.4	-0.8	1.4	1.4	1.5	1.5	1.5	-1.2	1.6	1.5	1.1	0.4	1.3
Net exports (\$bn, chained \$2017)	-969	-1002	-1075	-1151	-1219	-1239	-1258	-1272	-	-	-	-	-	-
Exports (goods and services)	-3.2	10.9	4.5	2.5	2.5	1.5	1.5	1.0	1.1	5.0	1.2	1.6	4.4	1.9
Imports (goods and services)	-1.0	11.8	11.5	10.0	9.0	3.0	3.0	2.0	-1.9	10.6	2.5	2.7	3.7	5.2
Inventories (ch \$bn, chained \$2017)	-15.6	-16.7	-50.8	27.4	63.0	67.7	68.7	67.6	-	-	-	-	-	-
Contribution to real GDP growth (% pts):														
Domestic final sales	0.6	2.2	3.2	2.4	2.3	2.5	2.6	2.0	1.8	2.5	2.2	2.4	2.2	2.3
Net exports	-0.2	-0.4	-1.0	-1.2	-1.1	-0.3	-0.3	-0.2	0.4	-0.9	-0.2	-0.1	0.0	-0.5
Inventories	0.1	0.2	-0.7	1.3	0.6	0.1	0.0	0.0	-0.2	0.4	0.0	-0.1	-0.1	0.2
Income and profits (NIPA basis)														
Adjusted corp profits	26.3	7.0	14.4	8.6	8.2	7.2	6.3	6.8	6.4	9.5	6.3	7.3	13.1	7.6
Real disposable personal income	-0.9	0.9	-1.5	0.7	0.8	1.4	1.7	1.1	1.0	0.2	1.5	1.7	0.2	1.1
Nominal disposable personal income	2.0	5.5	3.6	3.3	4.1	3.4	3.9	3.7	3.9	4.2	3.8	4.3	3.8	3.7
Saving rate ¹	3.8	3.9	2.8	2.6	2.4	2.3	2.2	2.1	-	-	-	4.6	2.9	2.2
Prices and labor cost														
Consumer price index	2.5	3.6	6.1	1.3	3.3	1.3	1.7	2.5	2.7	3.6	2.1	2.7	3.4	2.3
Core	2.0	2.8	2.9	2.0	2.8	2.6	2.5	2.6	2.7	2.6	2.6	2.9	2.6	2.6
PCE deflator	2.9	4.6	5.1	2.6	3.3	1.9	2.1	2.6	2.8	3.9	2.4	2.6	3.7	2.7
Core	2.7	4.4	3.4	3.2	3.1	2.8	2.6	2.7	2.9	3.5	2.7	2.8	3.4	2.9
GDP chain-type price index	3.7	3.6	6.2	2.6	3.3	1.9	2.1	2.6	3.3	3.9	2.4	2.8	3.9	2.7
S&P/C-S house price index (%oya)	1.3	0.8	0.9	0.0	0.0	3.0	3.0	3.0	1.3	0.0	3.0	2.2	0.4	3.0
Employment Cost Index	3.0	3.7	3.0	3.0	3.1	3.2	3.3	3.4	3.4	3.2	3.3	3.5	3.3	3.2
Productivity	1.6	0.3	0.3	2.6	1.3	2.4	2.0	1.6	2.5	1.1	1.7	2.3	1.7	1.8
Other indicators														
Housing starts (mn units, saar) ¹	1.323	1.418	1.347	1.350	1.350	1.350	1.400	1.400	-	-	-	1.356	1.366	1.388
Industrial production, mfg.	-3.6	1.4	4.7	1.2	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.3	2.1	1.0	0.8	1.2	1.3
Light vehicle sales (mn units, saar) ¹	15.7	15.5	16.3	15.5	15.5	15.8	15.8	15.8	-	-	-	16.2	15.7	15.8
Unemployment rate ¹	4.5	4.3	4.3	4.1	4.1	4.0	4.0	4.0	-	-	-	4.3	4.2	4.0
Payroll employment (ch, '000s, samr) ¹	-30	43	115	50	100	100	50	50	-	-	-	26	77	63
Nominal GDP	4.2	5.8	7.9	5.1	5.1	4.2	4.4	4.4	5.4	6.0	4.4	5.0	6.1	4.8
Current account balance (\$bn) ¹	-221	-227	-257	-266	-275	-285	-285	-285	-	-	-	-1177	-1025	-1140
% of GDP	-2.8	-2.8	-3.2	-3.2	-3.3	-3.4	-3.3	-3.3	-	-	-	-3.8	-3.1	-3.3
Federal budget balance (\$bn) ¹	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-1775	-2020	-1960
% of GDP	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-5.8	-6.3	-5.8

¹. Entries are average level for the period. Federal balance figures are for fiscal years.

	Aug 7	3Q26	4Q26	1Q27	2Q27	3Q27	4Q27
Interest rate forecast (end of period)							
Fed funds target (top of range)	3.75	3.75	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00	4.00
2-yr Treasury	4.17	4.25	4.30	4.30	4.30		
5-yr Treasury	4.36	4.45	4.45	4.45	4.45		
10-yr Treasury	4.70	4.80	4.85	4.85	4.85		
30-yr Treasury	5.27	5.35	5.40	5.40	5.40		

Source: J.P. Morgan

US economic calendar

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
17 Aug Empire State survey (8:30am) Aug <u>10.0</u> NAHB survey (10:00am) Aug <u>34</u> TIC data (4:00pm) Jun	18 Aug Housing starts (8:30am) Jul <u>1,310,000</u> Permits <u>1,370,000</u> Import prices (8:30am) Jul <u>-0.5%</u> Business leaders survey (8:30am) Aug Industrial production (9:15am) Jul <u>0.3%</u> Manufacturing <u>0.0%</u> Capacity utilization <u>76.2%</u> Pending home sales (10:00am) Jul <u>0.6%</u>	19 Aug Auction 20-year bond <u>\$16bn</u> FOMC minutes (2:00pm)	20 Aug Initial claims (8:30am) w/e Aug 15 <u>215,000</u> Philadelphia Fed manufacturing (8:30am) Aug <u>25.0</u> QSS (10:00am) 2Q adv Leading indicators (10:00am) Jul Auction 30-year TIPS (r) <u>\$8bn</u> Announce 2-year note <u>\$69bn</u> Announce 5-year note <u>\$70bn</u> Announce 2-year FRN (r) <u>\$28bn</u> Announce 7-year note <u>\$44bn</u>	21 Aug Services PMI (9:45am) Aug flash <u>53.5</u> Manufacturing PMI (9:45am) Aug flash <u>53.5</u>
24 Aug	25 Aug FHFA HPI (9:00am) Jun, 2Q S&P/Case-Shiller HPI (9:00am) Jun, 2Q New home sales (10:00am) Jul Consumer confidence (10:00am) Aug Richmond Fed survey (10:00am) Aug Auction 2-year note <u>\$69bn</u>	26 Aug Durable goods prelim (8:30am) Jul Real GDP (8:30am) 2Q second Personal income (8:30am) Jul Auction 5-year note <u>\$70bn</u> Auction 2-year FRN (r) <u>\$28bn</u>	27 Aug Advance economic indicators (8:30am) Jul Initial claims (8:30am) w/e Aug 22 KC Fed survey (11:00am) Aug Auction 7-year note <u>\$44bn</u>	28 Aug Consumer sentiment (10:00am) Aug final Fed Chair Warsh speaks at the Jackson Hole Symposium (10:00am, tentative)
Jackson Hole Economic Policy Symposium from 27 Aug to 29 Aug				
31 Aug Dallas Fed manufacturing (10:30am) Aug	1 Sep JOLTS (10:00am) Jul ISM manufacturing (10:00am) Aug Construction spending (10:00am) Jul Light vehicle sales Aug	2 Sep ADP employment (8:15am) Aug Durable goods (10:00am) Factory orders (10:00am) Jul Beige book (2:00pm)	3 Sep Productivity and costs final (8:30am) 2Q International trade (8:30am) Jul Initial claims (8:30am) w/e Aug 29 Services PMI (9:45am) Aug final ISM services (10:00am) Aug Announce 3-year note <u>\$58bn</u> Announce 10-year note (r) <u>\$39bn</u> Announce 30-year bond (r) <u>\$22bn</u>	4 Sep Employment (8:30am) Aug
7 Sep Labor Day, Markets closed	8 Sep NFIB survey (6:00am) Aug Consumer credit (3:00pm) Jul Auction 3-year note <u>\$58bn</u>	9 Sep QSS (10:00am) 2Q Auction 10-year note (r) <u>\$39bn</u>	10 Sep PPI (8:30am) Aug Initial claims (8:30am) w/e Sep 5 Wholesale trade (10:00am) Jul Existing home sales (10:00am) Aug Auction 30-year bond (r) <u>\$22bn</u>	11 Sep CPI (8:30am) Aug Consumer sentiment (10:00am) Sep preliminary Federal budget (2:00pm) Aug

Source: Private and public agencies and J.P. Morgan. Further details available upon request.

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Completed 14 Aug 2026 06:46 PM EDT

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